

Adult ADHD: task starts and external scaffolds

Original support worksheet | Adults | Reviewed 2026-10-10

Use fictional or appropriately de-identified notes. Write, draw, dictate or point. Not a validated measure, diagnostic test or crisis service.

Wanted task: Purpose and actual demand

Start bottleneck: Unclear, costly, inaccessible

External scaffold: Cue, materials, first action

Attempt: Start and next step

Review: Benefit, burden, other explanations

Task and the first visible action

What blocks that action: uncertainty, materials, capacity or fear?

One scaffold I choose and when it will be available

What happened to start, completion and effort?

Next step: who will do what, by when, and how will we review helpfulness or harm?

Major sleep change, mood activation, severe depression, substance concerns or inability to meet basic needs needs clinical assessment. Do not advise medication changes or use task success as diagnostic proof.